

BACKGROUND GUIDE

Historical Crisis Committee



UNITED NATIONS

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Table of Contents

1. Letter from the EB
2. Introduction to the committee
3. Background Guide
4. Reference Guide
5. Rules of Procedure for HCC

LETTER FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to the Historical Crisis Committee of TFS JMUN 2026. We look forward to the debates and decision-making you bring to the table. Your unique skills will be put to test and we believe all of you have what it takes to weather the storm of crisis. On behalf of the Executive Board, we extend our warmest greetings and congratulate each of you on being a part of what promises to be an intellectually stimulating and dynamic committee.

The year is **1814**. Napoleon Bonaparte has been defeated, and Europe stands at a defining crossroads. The great powers have assembled in Vienna to restore stability after decades of revolution and war. Yet beneath the façade of diplomacy lie competing ambitions, fragile alliances, and the ever-present possibility that history may take an entirely different course.

As delegates, you are not merely representing historical personalities—you are becoming them. Your decisions, negotiations, alliances, and directives will shape the future of Europe. Remember that this is a **Historic Crisis Committee**, where creativity, strategic thinking, and adaptability are just as important as historical knowledge. While history provides the foundation, your actions may lead to outcomes that diverge significantly from the events we know today.

We encourage every delegate to come well-prepared with an understanding of their portfolio's objectives, relationships, and political motivations. Research should extend beyond basic facts to include the interests, ambitions, and constraints of the individual you represent. Strong diplomacy, persuasive debate, and innovative crisis directives will distinguish successful delegates throughout the committee.

The Executive Board values respectful discourse, constructive collaboration, and adherence to parliamentary procedure. We encourage healthy competition while maintaining professionalism and mutual respect at all times. Every delegate, regardless of prior MUN experience, will have the opportunity to contribute meaningfully to the committee's proceedings.

We look forward to witnessing thought-provoking debates, carefully crafted directives, and innovative solutions as you navigate one of the most consequential diplomatic gatherings in European history. Whether Europe emerges united, divided, or transformed entirely will depend on the choices you make.

Prepare to negotiate, strategize, and rewrite history.

We wish you the very best and eagerly await your participation.

Warm regards,

Your Chairs,
Priyanshi Raj and Pranav Vasudevan

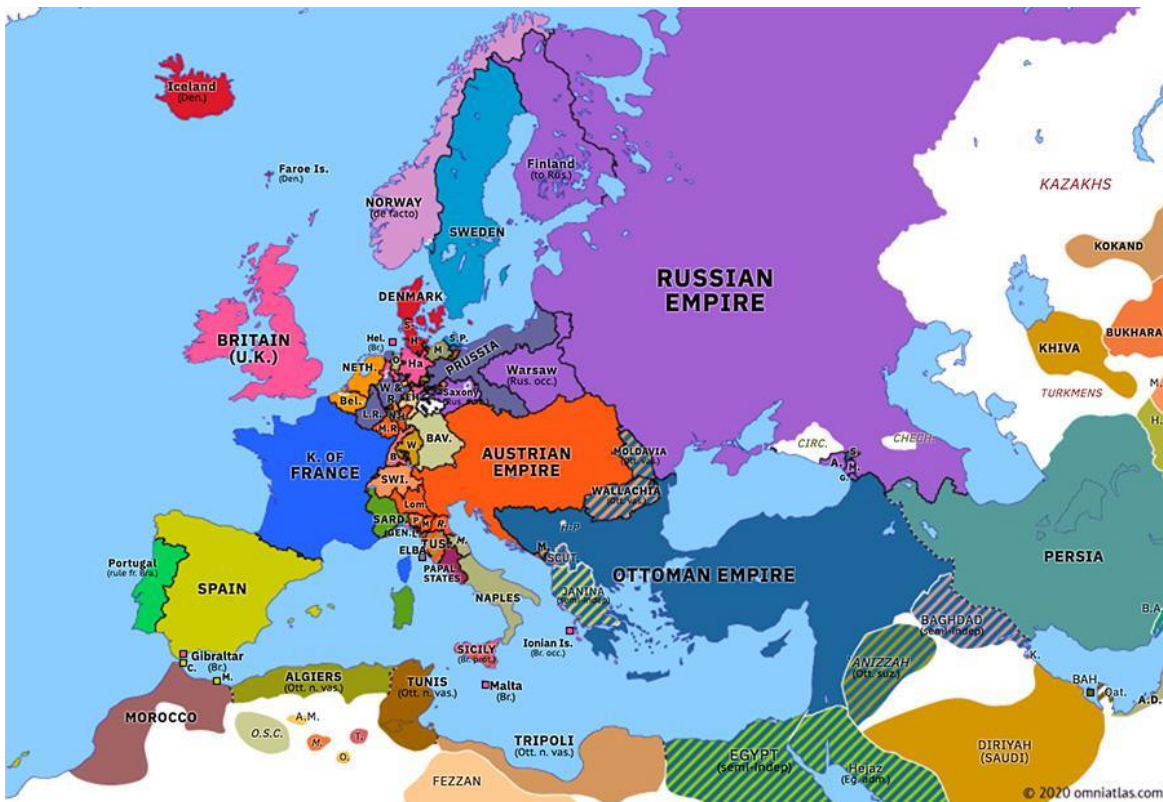
Introduction to the Committee

The Historic Crisis Committee (HCC) offers delegates an opportunity to step into the shoes of influential figures from the past and shape the course of history through diplomacy, strategy, and decisive action. Unlike conventional committees that focus on present-day issues, the HCC unfolds within a historical setting where every decision has the potential to alter the future. Delegates are expected not only to defend the interests of their assigned portfolios but also to respond to rapidly evolving crises, negotiate alliances, and draft innovative directives.

This committee is dynamic and fast-paced. While historical events provide the initial framework, the course of debate is determined entirely by the actions of the delegates. As the committee progresses, crises may emerge unexpectedly, compelling delegates to adapt their strategies and make difficult political, military, and diplomatic decisions under pressure.

For this committee, delegates will convene at the Congress of Vienna (1814–1815) following the defeat of Napoleon Bonaparte. Europe stands exhausted after decades of revolutionary upheaval and the Napoleonic Wars. The victorious powers must now determine how to restore peace, redraw borders, balance competing national interests, and ensure that no single state again dominates the continent. However, beneath the promise of stability lie conflicting ambitions, rivalries among the Great Powers, rising nationalist movements, and the lingering influence of Napoleon himself.

The success of this committee will depend on historical understanding, strategic foresight, effective negotiation, and the ability to think beyond the constraints of recorded history. Delegates are encouraged to embrace their portfolios, remain true to their historical motivations, and recognize that every speech, alliance, and directive may permanently reshape the destiny of Europe. Welcome to the Historic Crisis Committee. History has brought you to Vienna—what happens next is entirely in your hands.



Background to the Agenda

The Congress of Vienna (1814–1815) was one of the most significant diplomatic gatherings in European history. It convened after the defeat and abdication of Napoleon Bonaparte in 1814, bringing together the major European powers to restore peace and stability following over two decades of revolutionary upheaval and the Napoleonic Wars. Hosted in Vienna by the Austrian Foreign Minister, Prince Klemens von Metternich, the Congress sought not merely to negotiate peace but to reshape the political landscape of Europe.

The French Revolution of 1789 had dramatically altered the political order of Europe by challenging the principles of absolute monarchy and spreading ideals of liberty, equality, and nationalism. Napoleon Bonaparte capitalized on the revolutionary turmoil, rising from a military commander to Emperor of the French. Through a series of military campaigns, he expanded French influence across much of continental Europe, overthrowing monarchies, redrawing borders, and introducing legal and administrative reforms. While many welcomed these reforms, others viewed Napoleon's expansion as a threat to the sovereignty and balance of Europe.

By 1814, a coalition comprising Austria, Russia, Prussia, and the United Kingdom had defeated Napoleon, forcing him to abdicate and accept exile on the island of Elba. With the immediate threat removed, the victorious powers faced a far more complex challenge: determining how Europe should be governed in the aftermath of years of conflict. They sought to prevent another hegemonic power from emerging while ensuring that revolutionary ideals did not destabilize the continent again.

The Congress of Vienna was guided by several key principles. The first was the restoration of legitimacy, which aimed to return the traditional ruling dynasties that had been displaced during the Napoleonic era. The second was the balance of power, ensuring that no single nation could dominate Europe as France had under Napoleon. The third was collective security, encouraging the Great Powers to cooperate in preserving peace and suppressing future threats to the established order.

Among the most contentious issues before the Congress were the future of France, the territorial reorganization of Europe, the fate of Poland and Saxony, the formation of a new German Confederation, the independence and neutrality of various states, and the growing demands for nationalism and constitutional government. While the delegates publicly pursued peace and cooperation, each nation also sought to maximize its own strategic, political, and economic interests.

Although history records that the Congress ultimately established a relatively stable European order lasting nearly a century, this committee is a Historic Crisis Committee, where history is not predetermined. Delegates are expected to act in accordance with their assigned portfolios while responding to evolving crises, secret developments, and unexpected events. Every negotiation, alliance, military decision, and directive has the potential to alter the course of history.

As the representatives of Europe's most influential leaders, diplomats, monarchs, and military commanders, delegates bear the responsibility of deciding whether Europe will emerge united under a lasting peace, descend into renewed conflict, or witness the rise of an entirely new political order. The future of the continent lies in your hands.



Reference links

https://www.bundeskanzleramt.gv.at/en/federal-chancellery/visit-us/history/the-congress-of-vienna.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com

https://www.britannica.com/event/Congress-of-Vienna?utm_source=chatgpt.com

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https://www.napoleon.org/en/history-of-the-two-empires/articles/did-the-congress-of-vienna-undo-everything-napoleon-had-achieved/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

https://www.napoleon.org/en/history-of-the-two-empires/paintings/the-congress-of-vienna/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Rules of Procedure (ROP) for HCC

ROP is the procedure and rules which has to be followed by everyone to run the committee.

The rules of procedure contain the following parts:

- **Motions**-For anything to happen in the committee, a motion needs to be raised. Even to start the formal session, a motion needs to be raised to start it. Once a motion is raised, there will either be voting or the EB will exercise its discretion and pass it.
- **Role Call**-The committee starts with the role call. All the delegates' names will be called one by one, and everyone who's there simply has to say, "Present for Voting" or "Present."
- **General Speakers List (GSL)**- Basically the list of all delegates. Everyone has to give a GSL Speech. Most probably, it won't be done in one go. To start a GSL session, a motion has to be passed, specifying how many speakers and for how long.
- **Moderated Caucus (Mod Cauc)**- In broad topics like the American Civil War, there'll be many subtopics, for example. A Mod Cauc is simply a session where delegates give speeches and ask questions on a specific subtopic. Raising a motion to start one is done the same way as that of a GSL session.
- **Unmoderated Caucus (Unmod Cauc)**- Effectively a break from formal session, typically not exceeding 15 mins. Delegates can move around, talk to each other and try to get people on their side. DON'T USE IT AS LEISURE TIME, they're very important to strategise and decide your course of action. To raise a motion to start one, only the duration needs to be specified.
- **Points**- Points are raised individually for immediate reasons.Types (listed in order of importance):
 - **Point of Personal Privilege**- To use the washroom, turn on the fan, etc.
 - **Point of Order (POO)**-If a delegate said something wrong in their speech. Only 1 POO is entertained after a speech.

Types:

- **Point of Factual Inaccuracy (POFI)**- To point out something completely wrong.
- **Point of Logical Fallacy (POLF)**- If there's something wrong with the delegate's logic.
- **Point of Information (POI)**-Raised by other delegates after a delegate's speech, to ask questions.
- **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry (POPI)**-To ask questions to the EB about the flow of committee. Ex: How many speakers are left in GSL?

Yields- If a delegate's speech is done but there's still time left, he/she can yield their remaining time in the following ways:

- Yield for Questions-Allowing other delegates to
- raise POIs on their speech.
- Yield to the EB-Giving the remaining time to the
- EB. We can allow or disallow POIs at this time.

Chits- If a delegate wants to raise a point on another delegate's speech but doesn't get to do so, they can send chits to the delegate and ask their questions on it. Write the question on a chit, fold it, write 'To:' and 'From:(Your delegation)', and simply hand it to the logistics. If you write 'Via EB' it'll pass through the EB first and it'll get marked, if not, it'll go directly to the delegate.

- **Directives**-For any action to happen in the war, a directive needs to be written on it. They can be covert (where no one except the EB knows who wrote it) or overt (where it's read out to the whole committee and voting takes place for it). A directive needs to be as detailed as they can be.

Directive Format

(Covert/Overt) Operation Name

From: Delegates

Type: Joint/Individual/Committee wide

Signatories: Signatories

To: The Executive Board Objective:

What you want to do Materials Required:

Resources Plan of action: How you want to do it Procedure: How you're going to do it

Expected outcome: What you expect to happen

War directives examples:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tLGQumSFXpe_4rbM0sIryugS1emfY5WtLnF5oXVp8/edit?tab=t.0

- **Communiques-** If you want to involve or ask for things from someone who isn't present in the committee, a communicate needs to be written to the related person.

FORMAT OF A COMMUNIQUE

To: Recipient From: Who Wrote It

Subject: What you want to do

The recipient:

Your concern and action

Yours sincerely;

Who Wrote It

Communique Link:

https://docs.google.com/document/d/15IpRWDVs5PgAuGJSzs8rSFwsn_1DaCDEa_zHzZgMnGA/edit?tab=t.0

- **Press Release:** If you want to reveal something to the committee, write a press release about it.
- **Right to Reply(RTR):** If a delegate says something absolutely outrageous in their speech, the concerned delegates can raise an RTR against that delegate. An RTR is effectively a 1v1 debate. However, an RTR needs to be raised on proper grounds. You can't just have a baseless RTR, there needs to be a reason for it. Don't be scared to raise one; you get handsome returns if you win it. If you lose, you get demarcated by 1 point.

THANK YOU